

| By Saurabh Shukla |

After Pakistan admitted last week that Mumbai attacks were planned on its soil, it sent India a list of 30 questions, which it said were essential to be answered before it could take further action against the guilty. The ball is now in India's court. Since then there has been a slew of meetings in the home ministry and the Ministry of External Affairs to decide on the response. The urgency arises as India doesn't want Pakistan to either divert attention from the terror issue or for it to say that India is not cooperating in the probe.

INDIA TODAY has obtained exclusive details of Pakistan's note verbale, including the 30 posers, sent to India. Most of the questions are specific and seek details of the Indian probe, including Ajmal Amir Kasab's confessions in court, recent photographs of the nine dead terrorists, DNA samples, fingerprints and other identity particulars. Pakistan, however, has also raised some tricky questions about the circumstances related to Mumbai ATS chief Hemant Karkare's death. This, besides hinting at the role of Indians in the Mumbai attacks by seeking to know how the attackers managed to get Indian SIM cards and why the Indian Navy could not intercept them.

The note says that based on the information provided by India and its own investigations into the Mumbai attacks, Pakistan had filed FIR No 01-2009 in the special investigation unit of the Federal Investigation Agency against eight suspected terrorists. It says these clarifications and information are essential for Islamabad to complete the investigations and to get the accused convicted in a court of law. Pakistan also said six of the eight accused of the Mumbai plot belonged to the now defunct Lashkar-e-Toiba, had been taken into custody and were being interrogated. It also said links to the conspiracy were found in other nations, including the US, Austria, Spain, Italy and Russia. Sources say, the Indian response, which is currently being drafted, may ask Pakistan



# A Question of ANSWERS

In its reply to the Mumbai attack dossier, Pakistan poses some tricky questions that has India groping for answers

to allow Indian investigators to question those eight suspects and piece the missing links together. Pakistan, meanwhile, has indicated that it may want to question Kasab.

Indian experts view Pakistan's posers seeking details on the circumstances leading to the death of Karkare as not without political motive. Islamabad has also sought interrogation reports of two Indians, Tausif Rehman and Mukhtar Ahmed Sheikh, who were arrested in Kolkata for allegedly providing SIM cards to the attackers. Besides, the poser on how they got Indian SIM cards is being viewed as an attempt by Pakistan to

strengthen the theory that there may have been strong Indian links to the attacks. Not satisfied with the transcripts of the conversation Delhi had given, Islamabad is also insisting on tapes of recordings of the conversation of the Mumbai attackers and those of the conversations they had with their Pakistan-based handlers. Sources say this could be a complicated process as giving actual tapes that run into more than 60 hours may not be feasible. Besides, it may also compromise the source of interception.

Analysts question Islamabad's motives. "If they are not capable of probing the assassination of their former